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Applying for: Associate General Counsel, Figure, San Jose, CA

SUMMARY

IP infrastructure built for the part of this role that never stops moving: a hardware and AI company whose value sits in patents and vendor agreements that all have to hold up as the product ships faster than the paperwork. Three years spent turning that exposure into something managed, not something hoped for.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Invention Capture & Portfolio Buildout, Enveda Biosciences *Series B biotech · small legal team, high R&D velocity*

- Replaced a disclosure process engineers were quietly avoiding with AI-assisted intake that meets inventors where they already work: the direct equivalent of pulling patentable work out of engineers who don't recognize it as inventive.
- Migrated the full legacy portfolio in 30 minutes and became the IP team's system of record from day one, with no separate change-management project required.
- Gave a newly onboarded IP team member a working command center instead of a dependency on outside counsel for basic status checks, called "game-changing" from the first login.

Portfolio Strategy & Board Reporting, Woodward *industrial hardware manufacturer*

- Built patent-to-product mapping and board-ready KPI reporting for a hardware manufacturer transitioning off a legacy docketing system, the same "which three patents protect the core product" question every platform and prosecution effort ultimately has to answer.
- Selected over competing IPMS platforms specifically for configurability and fit with the client's existing product-lifecycle process, rather than for the AI drafting capability that later became the differentiator.

CORE CAPABILITIES MAPPED TO THIS ROLE

- Hardware and robotics patent strategy: portfolio-to-product mapping and competitive whitespace analysis, so IP protection keeps pace with what's actually shipping.
- Invention harvesting from hardware and robotics engineering: structured, low-friction intake built because inventive work at a fast-moving hardware company routinely gets missed, not because it isn't patentable.
- Consistent IP terms across vendor and manufacturing agreements: a flat-fee prosecution and outside counsel benchmark for cost, quality, and turnaround, so protecting IP in the supply chain doesn't depend on which firm drafted which agreement.

WHERE I STOP

The GPU compute procurement, the data-privacy compliance work, and the cross-border trade questions in this role sit outside what I do, and I'd rather say that directly than have it discovered later. Where I can help is making sure the IP side of Figure's stack, the patents, the vendor IP terms, has real infrastructure under it before it becomes someone's full-time headache.